

Burris, Thompson & Associates

Proposal for

**COMPREHENSIVE
CLASSIFICATION/COMPENSATION
STUDY**

for the

City of Spring Hill

In Response to RFP dated October 17, 2022

December 1, 2022

Burris Thompson

BTA
& Associates

Burris, Thompson & Associates

Contact: Steve Thompson

3259 Vinemont Drive

Thompson's Station, TN 37179-2924

(615) 500-7931

e-mail: stevenjthompson@comcast.net

COMPREHENSIVE CLASSIFICATION/COMPENSATION STUDY

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*Compensation and
Talent Management
Consultants*

Steve Thompson
President, Consulting Services
3259 Vinemont Drive
Thompson's Station, TN 37179-2924
Phone: (615) 500-7931
stevenjthompson@comcast.net

December 1, 2022

Rick Stokes
HR Director
City of Spring Hill
199 Town Center Parkway
Spring Hill, TN 37174

Dear Rick,

Burris, Thompson & Associates is pleased to present the enclosed proposal for the Comprehensive Classification/Compensation Study for the City of Spring Hill.

Burris, Thompson & Associates is highly qualified to conduct the Study based on our prior work with Spring Hill and extensive public sector compensation consulting experience in Tennessee.

Note that samples of a job description and a study report are not included – would result in exceeding RFP stipulated 20 page limit. Additionally, we assume the City has an established job description format and it is against our policy to provide sample reports – when provided in the past they were misinterpreted as being indicative of the details of the Study approach we would take when in fact such details are customized to particular client circumstances.

We would very much enjoy working with City staff on this project. Please contact me if you have any questions concerning our proposal.

Sincerely,

Steve Thompson

Enc: USB flash drive

I. Proposer Qualifications

A. Firm Overview

Burris & Associates (now **Burris, Thompson & Associates**) was founded in 1982 by Don Burris, CCP, and has served clients in Tennessee, Kentucky, Florida and nationally. **Burris, Thompson & Associates** consultants are sole proprietors. The firm's offices are located in Nashville, Tennessee.

The firm offers a wide range of human resources management consulting services, but the majority of consulting engagements are related to compensation management. The firm's consultants have worked with a variety of clients to develop job evaluation, base pay, individual and team incentive, skill based pay, executive compensation, performance management, and sales incentive programs.

Burris, Thompson & Associates serves mostly small to medium size organizations in a variety of industries and the public sector (approximately 90% of the firm's work is with public sector clients).

Burris, Thompson & Associates' primary areas of expertise include:

- Wage and salary administration plan design
- Job documentation and evaluation
- Compensation and benefits surveys
- Incentive plan design
- Strategic human resources planning
- Competency modeling
- Performance management
- Employee development
- Legal compliance

Biannually, we conduct a public sector salary survey of city and county governments and public utilities in Tennessee and surrounding states. We have just published the results of our 2022 survey – it includes data from 77 participants for more than 160 job titles. This represents the most comprehensive current data on public sector wages and salaries available for Tennessee.

B. Past Clients

Burris, Thompson & Associates have performed work similar to that requested by the City for the following (* if ongoing relationship of five to ten years):

City of Athens, TN*	Coffee County, TN
City of Bartlett, TN	Hartsville/Trousdale County Metro Gov't.
City of Bowling Green, KY	Madison County, TN
City of Brentwood, TN*	Maury County, TN
City of Clarksville, TN	Montgomery County, TN
City of Cleveland, TN	Rutherford County, TN
City of Collegedale, TN	Sevier County, TN
City of Cookeville, TN	Smith County, TN
City of Franklin, TN*	Sumner County, TN
City of Gatlinburg, TN*	Williamson County, TN*
City of Germantown, TN*	Wilson County, TN*
City of Goodlettsville, TN*	Fayetteville (TN) Public Utilities*
City of Greenbrier, TN	Gibson County Utility District
City of Hendersonville, TN	Paris-Henry County Public Utility District
City of Jackson, TN*	Humphreys County 911
City of Lakeland, TN	Rutherford County 911
City of Lebanon, TN*	Clarksville-Montgomery County Schools*
City of LaVergne, TN*	Franklin Special School District
City of McMinnville, TN	Hamilton County Schools
City of Murfreesboro, TN	Maury County Public Schools
City of Pigeon Forge, TN	Oak Ridge Schools
City of Shelbyville, TN	Huntsville-Madison County Public Library
City of Sparta, TN	Williamson County Public Library
City of Springfield, TN	Middle Tennessee State University
City of Spring Hill, TN	University of Tennessee
City of Tullahoma, TN*	Nashville Career Advancement Center
City of Waverly, TN*	Community Action Center of Southern KY
City of White House, TN	TN State Department of Human Resources
Town of Nolensville, TN	TN DHS (as subcontractor for Peabody College of Vanderbilt)
Town of Signal Mountain, TN	TDOT (as subcontractor for UT, Institute for Public Service)
Town of Smyrna, TN*	

C. Project Staff

Professional staff that would work with the City on this project include (resumes can be found in Appendix I):

Steven Thompson

President, Consulting Services, Burris, Thompson & Associates

Education: BA Psychology - University of Minnesota
MS Industrial Relations - Purdue University

Mr. Thompson has 30 years of practical and consulting experience in the compensation field. He has held compensation management positions with Melvin Simon and Associates, Inc. (real estate development and retail property management) and Dollar General Corporation (retail). As a member of the management services arm of a regional public accounting firm, and since 1994

with Burris, Thompson & Associates, Mr. Thompson has provided consulting services related to many aspects of human resources management to a variety of for-profit and non-profit organizations, including local government.

Mr. Thompson will be the Project Manager and will perform all of the work.

Elizabeth Thomsen Consultant

Education: BA Marketing – Austin Peay State University
MBA – Belmont University

Ms. Thomsen has 21 years of practical experience divided between the compensation and retirement fields with the latter three years managing the operations of both combined. She held compensation and retirement management positions with Ingram Industries Inc. (the parent organization for an inland marine transportation company and a content distribution company). During her tenure at Ingram, Ms. Thomsen led the corporate and executive compensation functions and was responsible for the management, administration, and compliance of numerous qualified and nonqualified retirement plans. She also completed several projects for the organization's profit centers and a number of external for-profit and non-profit organizations.

Ms. Thomsen will be involved in compilation of the market data from the public sector benchmarks.

D. References

References for work that **Burris, Thompson & Associates** have performed similar to that requested by the City of Spring Hill include:

Reference Name: **City of Franklin, TN**
Contact Name: Kevin Townsel, HR Director
e-mail: kevin.townsel@franklintn.gov
Address: 109 Third Ave. South, Suite 102, Franklin, TN 37064
Telephone: (615) 791-3216

Reference Name: **Williamson County, TN**
Contact Name: Mike Weber, HR Director
e-mail: mike.weber@williamsoncounty-tn.gov
Address: 1320 West Main Street, Suite 112, Franklin, TN 37064
Telephone: (615) 591-8509

Reference: **Town of Smyrna, TN**
Contact Name: Jeff Craig, HR Director
e-mail: jeff.craig@townofsmyrna.org
Address: 315 S. Lowry Street, Smyrna, TN 37167
Telephone: (615) 459-7942

II. Proposed Approach to Compensation Study

A. Study Scope and Objectives

The City of Spring Hill has 300 FTE employees assigned to approximately 100 job classifications, each assigned to one of 34 pay grades (of which 21 are for public safety). The study will encompass all jobs and employees.

As indicated in the RFP, the present study is intended to be an update of the City's current wage and salary plan. The primary objectives for the study based on the RFP, subject to confirmation and modification by City management, include the following:

- Ensure that the City's pay practices are competitive in order to attract and retain the required talent to provide quality services to citizens (this includes ensuring that all employees are assigned to the appropriate job titles and that individual employee compensation accurately reflects the nature of the work being performed).
- Ensure internal equity of compensation across functional areas, especially for the same or similar job classifications, and that pay is administered in a fair and consistent manner.
- Assess the competitiveness of the City's employee benefits package and work with the City to determine how this should be considered in updating the pay plan.

Burris, Thompson & Associates project consultants will seek opportunities to involve the HR Director and department heads in the definition of job classifications, review of market data, consideration of different pay plan designs (if applicable), review of proposed pay structure, and development of a pay administration policy. Periodic progress reviews are identified in the tentative proposed work plan (see section IV below).

B. Fact Finding

1. City Management Direction

Burris, Thompson & Associates will attend an initial meeting with the City Administrator, HR Director, and other designated management staff members to discuss pay plan objectives, Study parameters, and to develop/confirm the City's pay strategy and how it supports the operational objectives of the City's various departments. The pay strategy would include definition of the competitive labor market for the City, desired positioning relative to that market, extent to which the current pay plan design may be modified based on City input, affordability, and other related issues. These pay plan objectives and parameters would guide completion of the market data analysis and development of Study recommendations.

2. Department Head Interviews

Interviews with department heads will serve two purposes. First, the project consultant would ask each department head to review the organization of work and the various positions in their areas (discussion is usually driven by review of departmental organization chart). We would

also seek information related to anticipated organizational or technology changes that may need to be considered. (See Job Analysis below.) Second, we would obtain feedback concerning current pay practices, including current and desired job classification and pay plan design considerations.

3. Review Pay Plan Documentation

Burris, Thompson & Associates will review current City job classifications and pay ranges, pay administration policies, and other documentation of pay practices.

C. Job Analysis

1. Review Job Descriptions

Burris, Thompson & Associates will review all City job descriptions and organization charts to facilitate valid benchmarking to the salary survey data. We primarily compare job functions and qualifications – not just job titles. We will identify job descriptions that seem out of date and suggest some edits but complete overhaul of job descriptions is not within the scope of the Study. We will also evaluate and recommend FLSA status for all jobs.

2. Employee Job Analysis Questionnaires

To supplement job descriptions, collection of job content information from employees may be desirable for some or all positions. To accomplish this, Burris, Thompson & Associates will develop a job content questionnaire for employees to complete (See Appendix II for an outline of a sample job analysis questionnaire – actual questionnaire is seven pages, including “white space” for responses).

As deemed to be necessary to supplement existing job descriptions, the City would distribute the questionnaire to employees representing some or all job classifications for them to complete. Upon completion by employees, supervisors would review and approve/supplement questionnaires. All questionnaires would then be forwarded to Burris, Thompson & Associates.

Burris, Thompson & Associates will review all completed questionnaires.

3. Job Analysis Interviews

As indicated above, Burris, Thompson & Associates will conduct job analysis interviews with **all** department heads in which they would describe all jobs in their office or department. If needed to supplement these discussions and the employee completed questionnaires, we can interview selected individual employees to ensure understanding of job responsibilities and required competencies and qualifications. In the interests of timeliness of Study completion, controlling project costs, and minimizing disruption of City operations, we anticipate that these job incumbent interviews will be limited to only those deemed to be critically necessary.

D. Review Employee Job Title Assignments

Based on review of employee job questionnaires, department head discussions, and existing job descriptions, Burris, Thompson & Associates will review the job titles of all employees. We will recommend assignment of employees to different job titles that match the employees' job duties and responsibilities where appropriate. Work on other similar engagements suggests that there will likely be only a few recommended changes.

E. Identify Market Data Sources

Burris, Thompson & Associates will compile comparative salary and benefits data from available published sources representing local government employers and general business and industry. Sources that may be used include:

- **Burris, Thompson & Associates' 2022 Public Sector Salary Survey** – with City management, we will review the set of public sector benchmark employers used in the pay study we completed for the City in 2020. This same set of benchmarks could be used for the current Study, though some additions or deletions may be appropriate. We just published the results of our 2022 survey – 77 cities and counties participated in the survey, likely including most if not all that Spring Hill would choose to be included in the comparison group for the present study. We can solicit data from any that did not.
- **Economic Research Institute Salary Assessor**, an extensive computer database updated quarterly that contains data for more than 4,000 job titles, filtered by industry and location. This database would be used for data representing general business and industry in the Maury/Williamson county area.
- **US Bureau of Labor Statistics - Area Occupational Employment and Wage Estimates**. This database would be used for data representing general business and industry in the Middle Tennessee area.
- **KFF (Kaiser Family Foundation Employer Health Benefits 2022 Annual Survey)**.
- Other data sources that might be provided by the City.

F. Compile Market Salary Data

For each City job we will then compile data from the survey or surveys that contain a job that matches an understanding of the job gained from the incumbent completed job questionnaire, department head discussion, and the City's job description. The benchmark salary survey numbers used (i.e., market average, 60th percentile, etc.) will be based on the City's desired competitive position in the labor market that was defined by City management. We will work with City management to determine the appropriate salary planning date for the study – the date to which all data will be projected to create the 'snapshot' of the market. Typically, this is the beginning of the fiscal year, July 1, 2023, in this case, but the City could choose a more aggressive date.

Since cities compete for talent with general employers as well as other public sector employers, we usually recommend identifying a **public sector** data point and a **general employer** data point for

each job where appropriate. The average of these two benchmark salaries will represent the **market rate** for the job. (If desired by the City, the public sector data could be weighted more heavily than the general employer data.)

The market rate is for the job and is usually representative of salaries of employees in their jobs 5 to 7 years. Recent hires are typically paid slightly less than the market rates for their jobs while most employers allow salaries to exceed job market rates for those employees with many years of service, up to a limit that is usually 15% to 20% above the market rate.

For department head and certain senior level professional jobs, salary is often related to city population. Population can be a proxy for the degree of complexity of these jobs. Burris, Thompson & Associates will complete a regression analysis of the relationship between the salary data from the city government benchmarks and city population for those jobs. We can then plug in the City of Spring Hill's population in the resulting regression formula to determine a 'predicted' market salary rate (median, 60th percentile or other) based on population. This predicted market rate might be a more valid representation of the market value of the City of Spring Hill job than the overall survey sample average.

G. City of Spring Hill Benefits Market Comparison

Burris, Thompson & Associates will review the City's health insurance, vacation, sick leave, disability, and retirement benefit offerings and compare to public sector benchmark employer practices. This high level review is intended to determine how the City's benefits programs might impact the City's positioning of wages and salaries. However, design and implementation of benefit plan revisions is beyond the scope of the present study. Burris, Thompson & Associates may identify benefit plan design features that the City can pursue with its brokers, insurance carriers, plan administrators, and financial services providers.

H. City of Spring Hill Salaries Market Comparison

1. Structure Market Index

Burris, Thompson & Associates will calculate a Structure Market Index for each City of Spring Hill **job**. The Structure Market Index is the ratio of the current **Pay Range Midpoint** to the **Market Rate** for the job.

$$\text{Structure Index} = \text{Range Midpoint} \div \text{Job Market Rate}$$

Individual and aggregate Structure Index numbers will allow comparison of current City of Spring Hill **pay ranges** to market practice.

2. Salary Market Index

Burris, Thompson & Associates will calculate a Salary Market Index for each City of Spring Hill **employee**. The Salary Market Index is the ratio of the employee's current **salary** to the **Market Rate** for the employee's job.

$$\text{Salary Index} = \text{Employee Salary} \div \text{Job Market Rate}$$

Individual and aggregate Salary Indexes provide measures of the competitiveness of the City's current **employee salaries**, though they will vary by employee and by department, largely as a result of differences in job tenure.

I. Job Classification and Pay Structure

1. Confirm Jobs are Assigned to Appropriate Pay Grades

Burris Thompson & Associates will review the Structure Market Index calculated for each job and identify those jobs for which the index is low (typically 92% or so), indicating the current pay range is significantly below market. We will review these 'out of line' jobs as well as those that City staff perceive to be misaligned and may recommend changes in pay grade assignments. Note that in most cases these discussions of revised job pay grade classifications are tied to discussion and clarification of the job duties and qualifications in the job descriptions that result in changing how jobs are matched to the market data. Job descriptions may need to be further revised to more appropriately reflect how City of Spring Hill management views the jobs. In this manner, the Study addresses **internal equity**.

2. Review Job FLSA Status

Burris, Thompson & Associates will review the FLSA status of all jobs based on the federal guidelines and recommend changes as appropriate.

3. Revise Pay Structure(s)

Burris, Thompson & Associates will then review the design of the City's pay structures to identify possible modifications that could enhance competitiveness and/or simplify pay administration. City officials and management must determine what is acceptable and we can revise the pay structure(s) if needed.

We will work with the City to determine if a single pay structure for all jobs may be desirable or if separate pay structures for Fire and Police, usually tied to professional development, would be more appropriate.

Finally, we will recommend an adjustment to the pay ranges based on the market data to ensure competitiveness.

J. Employee Salary Adjustments and Cost Projections

1. Pay Plan Implementation/General Increases

Burris, Thompson & Associates would identify recommended adjustments to individual employee salaries that would be appropriate with implementation of the revised pay structure(s). Typically, these salary adjustments would be comprised of the following:

- Adjustments to pay range minimums if employees' salaries fall below the proposed pay ranges for their jobs.

- Salary adjustments to mitigate pay compression resulting from adjustment of employees to pay range minimums.
- A common general increase - Burris, Thompson & Associates would recommend a percent of payroll salary increase budget based on data concerning employers' salary increase budgets for 2023 and the position of the City's salaries relative to the market.

2. Pay Adjustments to Address Pay Compression

To address pay compression and internal equity we will help the City improve the linkage between actual employee pay rates and job (and City) tenure. This will mitigate pay compression between employees with differing lengths of service in their positions. A few additional adjustments may be needed to ensure reasonable "daylight" between pay rates of supervisors and their subordinates.

To accomplish this Burris, Thompson & Associates will analyze how closely current City of Spring Hill employee pay rates are correlated with time in job. We will then create a "formula" or scheme for adjusting pay based on job tenure. An example that could be modified to fit the City is as shown below.

Pay Range Target (% of Midpoint)	
JOB TENURE	TARGET
20 years or more	110%
15 but less than 20 years	107%
10 but less than 15 years	103%
7 but less than 10 years	99%
4 but less than 7 years	95%
2 but less than 4 years	91%
Less than 2 years	88%

For each employee, if his/her pay rate is not at or above the "Target" percent of range midpoint, pay would be adjusted to that rate. This "formula" or scheme could be applied before or after any City-wide general increase. It could incorporate fewer or more tenure categories and the targets can be set as aggressively as the City wishes or can afford. Total City tenure can be considered as well – often as an add on. For example, an extra 2% for 10 years, 4% for 15 years, and 5% for 20 or more years might be appropriate.

Once the methodology has been determined, Burris, Thompson & Associates will then apply it across all employees to determine the amount of salary adjustment that would be needed for each employee (many will not receive an adjustment as they are already above their "target" pay rates).

This suggested tenure based adjustment for each employee should be reviewed with the department head to ensure that it is appropriate given other considerations not considered by the "formula." Some additional pay adjustments may be needed to mitigate pay compression between supervisors and their subordinates.

3. Pay Adjustment Cost Projections

Burris, Thompson & Associates would project the total cost (including impact on FICA and retirement plan funding) of recommended employee salary adjustments. The affordability of this total cost would be reviewed with City management. The amounts and/or timing of the implementation of pay adjustments can be revised accordingly if needed.

K. Preliminary Review with Management

We will review preliminary recommendations (any recommended reassignment of employees to different job titles, job pay grade re-classifications, the proposed 2023/2024 pay structure, and recommended employee salary adjustments) with the HR Director and other senior management as appropriate. To ensure buy-in, once given the go ahead we typically review these preliminary recommendations with department heads and obtain their feedback. We will channel discussion of disputed job pay grade assignments to discussion of the jobs themselves – job duties and qualifications. Revision of any proposed job pay grades will be based on revised understanding of the nature of the jobs that in turn would lead to revising salary survey job matches in determining the market rates for jobs.

L. Review Pay Administration Policy

Burris, Thompson & Associates will help the City review existing pay administration policies and procedures, including how employees progress through pay ranges, and recommend changes based on feedback from department heads.

M. Develop Implementation Plan

Burris, Thompson & Associates will assist the City in creating a plan for implementing the new pay plan. The plan would include proposed effective date of pay changes, communication schedule (see section II N “Employee Communications” below) and pay change procedures as applicable.

The City may be able to fund all proposed pay adjustments at the time the revised compensation plan is implemented. If potential implementation costs are significant, we normally develop an alternative for implementing the revised compensation plan over a two-year (or, though rarely, three year) period for the City’s consideration. This involves our development of interim pay structures.

Burris, Thompson & Associates will train HR staff in the methodology for maintaining the pay plan, including classification of new jobs and periodic updating of the pay structure based on changing labor market conditions. Much of this would be documented in the pay policy.

N. Employee Communications

Employee communication during the course of the project will be important for general acceptance and understanding of how pay is determined. We will work with the City to develop some or all of the following as needed:

- Initial announcement and overview of the pay study.

- Background and instructions for completing the job questionnaires.
- Explanation of the methodology of the Compensation Study.
- Explanation of the Study findings and proposed pay plan (probably in a Questions and Answers format).

Although we believe that communications concerning pay programs should come mostly from City management – it is their program not ours – there may be instances in which Burris, Thompson & Associates may appropriately present findings of the classification and compensation study and explain the development and implementation of the new pay plan.

We will help City staff create a communications plan/schedule for implementing the various communications components.

O. Final Report of Findings and Recommendations

Upon completion of the Compensation Study, Burris, Thompson & Associates will prepare and present a report of findings and recommendations for discussion with the City. Included will be:

- Explanation of the pay study methodology.
- Market data for all jobs.
- Benefits comparison summary.
- Comparison of job market rates to:
 - Current City pay ranges.
 - Current City of Spring Hill employee salaries.
- Assignment of all jobs to pay grades and recommended pay ranges for all pay grades.
- Recommended individual employee pay adjustments resulting from:
 - Implementation of the pay plan.
 - Salary adjustments as needed to mitigate pay compression.
 - General annual increase.
- Calculation of estimated implementation costs and recommended implementation plan.
- Recommended revisions to pay policy.
- Pay plan implementation communication materials.

To aid in pay plan administration, the following deliverables will be provided in hard copy and in electronic format.

- **Job Table** – contains all jobs, their pay grades and pay steps (or ranges).
- **Pay Structure** – shows all pay grades and associated pay steps (or ranges).
- **Pay Policy** – any approved revisions.
- **Employee Roster** with job titles, recommended job grade and ranges, and recommended pay adjustments.

III. City Study Responsibilities

The project manager and primary contact regarding services outlined in this proposal will be:

Steve Thompson, President, Consulting Services
Burris, Thompson & Associates
3259 Vinemont Drive, Thompson's Station, TN 37179-2924
Phone: (615) 500-7931 stevenjthompson@comcast.net

We anticipate that the City will provide electronic versions of existing job descriptions in MS Word or PDF format and an employee roster in an Excel compatible format including, name, job title, department, pay rate, standard hours, and, if possible, date in job and date of hire for each employee. The City will also provide current pay plan and employee benefits documentation.

IV. Tentative Study Work Plan

Assuming a project beginning date of on or about December 30, 2022, and our anticipated workload, a tentative general timetable for the Study is below (subject to modification based on date of acceptance of proposal, fine tuning of the project approach and availability of City staff – dates included here provide idea of an approximate timetable).

Comprehensive Classification/Compensation Study Work Plan		
Project Activity	City of Spring Hill Staff Involvement	Work Completed by
Fact Finding - Initial planning meeting with HR Director and City Administrator; department head interviews.	HR Director & City Administrator; department heads.	January 13
Job Questionnaires – Development, distribution & completion by some or all employees. Deliverable: Questionnaire for distribution.	Employees complete job questionnaires; review by department heads.	Distribute to employees by January 6 . Employees complete by January 20
Job Analysis – Review of job questionnaires and job descriptions. Deliverable: Recommended job FLSA status report	Department heads input and feedback as needed.	January 27
Employee Job Title Assignments - Recommended assignment of employees to job titles; review by HR Director and City staff; consultant revision based on feedback. Deliverable: Employee roster with job title assignments.	Department heads review recommended employee job title reassignments and provide feedback to HR Director.	February 3
Compile Market Data and City vs. Market Comparison – Compile market data and compare to City pay structure and salaries; benefits comparison. Deliverables: 1) Structure Index Report; 2) Salary Index Report; 3) Benefits Market Comparison Report (see “G” and “H” on page 10.)	HR Director reviews deliverables and provides feedback.	February 10
Revise Pay Structure – Revise pay ranges and assignment of jobs to pay grades. Deliverable: Job Table (jobs, grades, and ranges)	HR Director and City Administrator review “Job Table” and provide feedback.	February 17
Recommend Pay Adjustments – Recommend individual employee pay adjustments; develop cost projections. Review with HR Director; revise based on feedback. Deliverable: Employee roster with proposed pay adjustments showing total costs.	HR Director reviews salary adjustments and provides feedback; HR Director reviews cost projections with finance and City Administrator.*	February 24

Compensation Study Work Plan (cont'd)		
Project Activity	City of Spring Hill Staff Involvement	Work Completed by
Preliminary Management Review – Meet individually with department heads to review “Job Table” and recommended employee salary adjustments for their offices/departments.	Department heads review “Job Table” and salary adjustments and provide feedback.	March 3
Revise “Job Table” and Salary Recommendations – Based on feedback from department heads, revise job pay grade assignments and employee salary adjustments. Review with HR Director. Deliverables: ‘Final’ 1) Job Table, 2) employee salary adjustments, and 3) cost projections	HR Director to review any revised ‘final’ job pay grade assignments and salary adjustments with department heads as appropriate. (Consultant can be involved as needed.)	March 10
Revise/Develop Pay Policy/Implementation Plan – Review pay administration policy and develop implementation plan; review with City management as needed. Deliverable: Revised Pay Policy	HR Director to review pay policy; may involve department heads as appropriate.	March 10 (Work can be coincident with other project steps)
Employee Communications – Development of communications materials; review by HR Director. Deliverables: 1) Two to four initial and subsequent employee memos; 2) Pay Study Q&A upon Study completion	HR Director to review and edit communications materials. Distribution of Pay Study Q&A to be determined.	Ongoing
Final Report – Develop and present final report to HR Director and City Administrator Deliverable: Final Report	HR Director and City Administrator	March 17
Presentation to Board of Mayor and Alderman		TBD

Note that the dates are “completed by” - Burris, Thompson & Associates will begin work on some steps while working on those with earlier “completed by” dates to ensure we avoid any delays.

*Also note that the budgetary impact of proposed pay changes will in large part be determined by late February/early March – hopefully in time for inclusion in City budget planning for fiscal year 2023/2024. Some fine tuning of the budget impact will flow from final completion of the Study but likely will not be substantial.

V. Consulting Fees

Our estimated fees for completion of this project are based on our anticipated hours of involvement. A not-to-exceed cost is provided in the Cost Proposal submitted under separate cover along with this proposal. Our fee estimate is effective through June 30, 2023.

Fees are normally billed monthly based on actual project consulting hours incurred, with an itemized listing documenting fees for each project component. If monthly billings are unacceptable, we can entertain other arrangements.

Appendix I – Consultant Resumes

Steven Thompson

EDUCATION

PURDUE UNIVERSITY, West Lafayette, IN, Master of Science in Industrial Relations
UNIVERSITY OF MINNESOTA, MORRIS, Morris, MN, Bachelor of Arts in Psychology

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BURRIS, THOMPSON & ASSOCIATES

Murfreesboro/Nashville, TN. Compensation and talent management consulting firm serving primarily small and medium sized organizations in a variety of industries and the public sector.

President, Consulting Services

2005 to present

Vice President, Consulting Services

1994 to 2005

Develop compensation, employee development, and other human resources programs for government, manufacturing, health care, and service industry clients.

DOLLAR GENERAL CORPORATION

Nashville, TN. Discount retailer: in 1994 the company operated more than 1,800 stores and two distribution centers in 24 states, employed more than 12,000 people and had sales exceeding \$1.3 billion.

Director, Human Resources

1993 to 1994

Directed employee relations, staffing, and compensation functions.

Director, Compensation & Benefits

1991 to 1993

Designed and implemented compensation program for all positions, including computer assisted job evaluation program and merit pay system. Developed and installed broad based cash and stock incentive programs that contributed to annual company sales increases in excess of 20%.

MELVIN SIMON AND ASSOCIATES, INC.

Indianapolis, IN. Real estate management and development. Portfolio included more than 60 million square feet of retail space (regional malls and community centers) in more than 35 states. Company employed 4,500 people in development, construction, property management, marketing, and administration.

Compensation Manager

1987 to 1991

Wage and Salary Administrator

1985 to 1987

Compensation Analyst

1983 to 1985

Contributed to development and administration of job evaluation and wage and salary programs, incentive plans, and performance management program.

CROWE, CHIZEK AND COMPANY, CPAS

South Bend, IN. Large regional public accounting firm.

Human Resources Consultant

1979 to 1983

Developed personnel policies, compensation programs, affirmative action plans, and other human resources programs for small financial services, manufacturing, and service companies.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

WORLD AT WORK (formerly American Compensation Association)

MIDDLE TENNESSEE SOCIETY FOR HUMAN RESOURCES MANAGEMENT

ELIZABETH THOMSEN

EDUCATION

BELMONT UNIVERSITY, Nashville, TN, Master of Business Administration

AUSTIN PEAY STATE UNIVERSITY, Clarksville, TN, Bachelor of Business Administration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BURRIS, THOMPSON & ASSOCIATES

Nashville, TN. Compensation, and talent management consulting firm serving primarily small and medium sized organizations in a variety of industries and the public sector.

Consultant

Jan. 2021 to Present

Develop compensation, employee development, and other human resources programs for government and service industry clients.

INGRAM INDUSTRIES INC.

Nashville, TN. Corporate holding company with a total of about 6,000 employees worldwide. Subsidiaries include Ingram Marine Group, which provides marine transportation on over 4,500 miles of America's inland waterways, and Ingram Content Group, which provides a variety of services to publishers, retailers, libraries, and educators to get more books into the hands of more readers.

Director, Corporate Compensation & Retirement

2016 to 2019

Directed all activities for corporate compensation and retirement departments. Redesigned and integrated compensation program and new performance appraisal system for corporate headquarters. Successfully completed IRS audit for defined benefit plan. Finalized plan termination for defined benefit pension plan. Reorganized and updated eligibility process for executive nonqualified deferred compensation plans.

Manager, Corporate Compensation

2008 to 2016

Managed all compensation related functions for the corporate headquarters and executives for the organization. Executed annual incentive plan payments and long-term incentive plan recommendations and awards. Performed complete analysis of compensation program for Ingram Marine Group, contributing to complete overhaul of the program. Redesigned communications for executive long-term incentive plans. Updated and/or wrote job descriptions for all corporate positions. Created deferred compensation plan for United Way of Metropolitan Nashville.

Manager, Corporate Pension & 401(k) Services

2003 to 2008

Led team in the administration and compliance of qualified and nonqualified plans for all United States and Canadian associates. Plan portfolio valued at approximately \$750 million covering nearly 6,000 active participants. Developed and implemented new retirement plan for Ingram Marine Group. Improved eligibility process and communications for executive nonqualified deferred compensation plans.

Supervisor, Pension & Thrift Services

2001 to 2003

Spearheaded assimilation of numerous qualified and nonqualified retirement plans resulting from major acquisition. Successfully completed DOL pension plan audit.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

SOCIETY FOR HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

MIDDLE TENNESSEE SOCIETY FOR HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

Appendix II
Outline - Job Analysis Questionnaire
(Would be customized to meet the needs of the City of Spring Hill)

Name: _____ Job Title: _____

Department/Office: _____

Reports To: Name: _____ Title: _____

Positions Supervised: _____

Date you started work in your current job: ____/____/____ Today's Date: ____/____/____

A. GENERAL PURPOSE OF JOB: In one or two sentences describe the job's primary purpose or contribution to the department or organization.

B. ESSENTIAL DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES:

Job Tasks: Briefly describe the six to ten most important functions and responsibilities of your job.

Percent of Time: For each task, indicate approximately how much of your time is required to perform the task. It may be helpful to think in terms of percentage of your workweek, a quarter, or even an entire year.

Work Output: For each task, identify the "product" or other output of the job task.

Skills: Finally, for each task indicate the two or three most important skills, abilities, or areas of knowledge you think are needed to complete the task.

C. SUPERVISORY RESPONSIBILITIES:

Does this job have supervisory responsibilities? (Please Circle) Yes No

Are there subordinate supervisors reporting to this job? (Please Circle) Yes No

If yes, how many subordinate *supervisors* report to this job? _____

Are there other non-supervisory employees who report directly to this job? (Please Circle) Yes No

If yes, how many non-supervisory employees are directly supervised by this job? _____

D. TRAINING The training required to obtain the knowledge and skills needed for successful performance of your job is usually a combination of formal education and on-the-job training/experience.

Required Education: Select the level of formal education required for most individuals to have obtained the knowledge needed to perform your job or provide a starting point for successful on-the-job training.

Required Experience: In addition to the education selected above, what is the **minimum** length of prior job related experience an applicant normally must have to be **fully qualified** to perform your job (that is, have the needed depth and breadth of knowledge and skill level to be able to successfully perform your job duties with little or no additional training):

E. EQUIPMENT OPERATED: List all types of equipment operated on the job (e.g., line trimmer, computer, printer, backhoe, excavator, dump truck, etc.)

F. COMPUTER USAGE: How do you use computers in your job? Please indicate the level in each of the following that best matches your job tasks (some things may not apply to your job). Note: applies primarily to non - IT Department jobs.

Word

_____ **Level 1:** Not applicable.

_____ **Level 2: Basic** - Largely use word processing as a digital typewriter following prescribed format; create basic tables, modify margins, add page numbering, generate addressed envelopes.

_____ **Level 3: Intermediate** - Formatting (multiple columns, insertion of graphics and Excel charts), use track changes features, create labels, use mail merge features.

_____ **Level 4: Advanced** - Create, organize and format outlines; create table of contents, add text boxes, work with forms and fields.

Excel

_____ **Level 1:** Not applicable.

_____ **Level 2: Basic** - Mostly data entry; can create basic spreadsheets using autofill, autosum, average, count, and other basic "formulas".

_____ **Level 3: Intermediate** - Create custom spreadsheets using subtotals, intermediate math formulas (percentiles, date calculations, etc.), database formulas (count if, look-up tables); create graphics (frequency distributions, bar charts), link two workbooks.

_____ **Level 4: Advanced** - Use complex financial, lookup/reference/ and database and chart functions (e.g., pivot tables, line plots, etc.), create macros.

Applications/Database

_____ **Level 1:** Not applicable.

_____ **Level 2:** Routine data entry; limited number of data fields and screens.

_____ **Level 3:** Routine data entry with some responsibility for data integrity; routine predefined database queries; limited number of screens.

_____ **Level 4:** Multiple screens; data entry with primary responsibility for data integrity; custom data base queries.

_____ **Level 5:** Multiple screens; wide variety of data entry with responsibility for data integrity; routine addition of data fields; use of graphics design, GIS or similar software; create SQL queries.

Internet

_____ **Level 1:** Not applicable.

_____ **Level 2:** Update web site(s) with provided content.

_____ **Level 3:** Create content and update web site content.

_____ **Level 4:** Contribute to design and programming of web site(s) via content management system.

_____ **Level 5:** Contribute to design and programming of web site(s) using HTML, XML, or similar language.

G. CERTIFICATES, LICENSES, and REGISTRATIONS: List the licenses, certificates, or registrations that are required to perform the essential duties of this job.

H. PHYSICAL DEMANDS: How much on-the-job time is spent in the following physical activities? Show the portion of time by checking the appropriate boxes below.

Does this job require that weight be lifted or force be exerted? If so, how much and how often (portion of your time on- the-job)? Check the appropriate boxes below.

	----- Portion of Time -----			
	Under None	1/3 1/3	To 2/3	Over 2/3
Up to 10 pounds	☐	☐	☐	☐
Up to 25 pounds	☐	☐	☐	☐
Up to 50 pounds	☐	☐	☐	☐
Up to 100 pounds	☐	☐	☐	☐
More than 100 pounds	☐	☐	☐	☐

I. WORK ENVIRONMENT: How much exposure to the following environmental conditions does this job require? Show the portion of time by checking the appropriate boxes below.

	---- Portion of Time ----			
	None	Under 1/3	1/3 To 2/3	Over 2/3
Wet or humid conditions (non-weather)				
Work near moving mechanical parts				
Work in high, precarious places				
Fumes or airborne particles				
Toxic or caustic chemicals				
Outdoor weather conditions				
Extreme cold (non-weather)				
Extreme heat (non-weather)				
Risk of electrical shock				
Work with explosives				

How much noise is typical for the work environment of this job? Check the appropriate level below.

- ☐ Very quiet (examples: forest trail, isolation booth for hearing test)
☐ Quiet (examples: library, private office)
☐ Moderate noise (examples: business office with computers and printers, light traffic)
☐ Loud (examples: large earth-moving equipment)
☐ Very loud (examples: jack hammer work)

J. ADDITIONAL COMMENTS (Optional) Provide any additional information you feel will be helpful for a clear understanding of your job responsibilities.

Reviewed by Supervisor _____ Date: ____/____/____